Read Words in Context

Vocabulary Words

advantage	**obstacle**
agent	**precaution**
challenge	**pursuit**
foundation	**rival**
genius	**scheme**
mainland	**target**
mechanic	**vehicle**
nuisance	

Word Learning Tip!

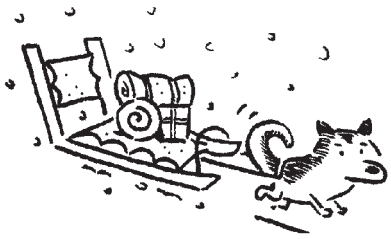
A **noun** is a word that names a person, place, or thing. Often a noun comes right after the little words *a*, *an*, or *the*. A noun often comes before a verb, too. Sometimes a noun ends in *-s*, *-es*, or *-ies*. You can use these clues to determine if an unknown word is a noun and if it names a person, place, or thing.

Vocabulary Building Strategy

Use Context Clues You can often find the meaning of nouns you don't know by using context clues. Read the sentence and think about the meanings of all the words to get a clue to the unknown word's meaning. Look for synonyms (words that mean the same thing) or phrases that give definitions.

READ!

Race for the North Pole



The race was on! In 1909 in the far north, Matthew Henson and Robert Peary struggled against icy blasts of wind. They traveled in a special **vehicle**—a dog sled—because cars and trucks could not pass across the frozen Arctic Ocean. That's because the **foundation** of the ocean is an unsteady base of gleaming ice chunks.

Their progress was slow and difficult. Icy winds prevented them from seeing. Huge boulders of ice blocked their path. Because of these **obstacles**, the men couldn't tell if they were on the **mainland**, on an island, or on the frozen ocean.

The bitter cold was more than a **nuisance**. It was a huge **challenge**, something to overcome. Frostbite was an ever-present danger. As a **precaution**, the men wore thick fur jackets, hats, and gloves to protect them from the biting wind.

Their **target** was the North Pole. They wanted to be the first to reach this goal. This was their fifth attempt! Would their **scheme**, or plan, work this time? Now they had a **rival**, another explorer named Frederick Cook. He, too, wanted to be the first to reach the North Pole. Cook was in close **pursuit,** just a little behind them.

Henson and Peary had two **advantages**. First, they got a lot of help from the Inuit people of the Arctic. Henson knew their language and could talk easily with them because he had worked with them as an **agent**, making deals for food and other supplies. Second, Henson was a **genius** when it came to fixing things. He was so clever and gifted at this that he served as the group's **mechanic**, repairing all the equipment.

On April 6, 1909, Matthew Henson and Robert Peary succeeded in being the first to reach the North Pole! They shouted in joy, raised the American flag, and then started the long journey home.

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Connect Words and Meanings

advantage	foundation	mechanic	precaution	scheme
agent	genius	nuisance	pursuit	target
challenge	mainland	obstacle	rival	vehicle

Directions Find the word that matches each description. Then use the words to fill in the blanks. After you have completed the entire puzzle, you will see another vocabulary word when you read down the squares. Write this word in the blank beside item 10.

	Word	Meaning
1.	☐ ___ ___ ___ ___	person who arranges things for other people or represents other people
2.	___ ___ ___ ___ ☐ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___	base; the basis on which something stands
3.	☐ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___	something used to carry people or objects over land or sea or through the air
4.	___ ___ ☐ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___	something difficult that requires extra effort or work to do
5.	☐ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___	a bother or annoyance
6.	☐ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___	goal or something that is aimed at
7.	___ ☐ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___	the largest mass of land of a country or continent
8.	☐ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___	an unusually intelligent and gifted person
9.	___ ☐ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___	person skilled at repairing machinery
10.	_____	something that helps a person or gives a person a better chance

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Connect More Words and Meanings

advantage	**foundation**	**mechanic**	**precaution**	**scheme**
agent	**genius**	**nuisance**	**pursuit**	**target**
challenge	**mainland**	**obstacle**	**rival**	**vehicle**

Directions Read each meaning. Circle the letter of the word that best fits this meaning.

11. **a plan or plot to do something**
A. genius **B.** agent **C.** mechanic **D.** scheme

12. **barrier**
A. pursuit **B.** target **C.** obstacle **D.** precaution

13. **someone or something that is an opponent or competitor**
A. rival **B.** mechanic **C.** agent **D.** genius

14. **the act or instance of chasing someone or something**
A. challenge **B.** pursuit **C.** vehicle **D.** mainland

15. **action taken ahead of time to prevent something dangerous from happening**
A. precaution **B.** foundation **C.** advantage **D.** pursuit

Directions Use your knowledge of word meanings to fill in the blanks in each sentence. Write the correct vocabulary words in the blanks.

16. One business might try to come up with a _____ to get an _____ over another business.

17. A _____ works hard to make sure a _____ is in safe condition.

18. Ramon and his _____ Jason each tried to jump over the _____ on the track.



Create a Chant Using at least three of your vocabulary words, work with some classmates to create a song, chant, or rhyme. You can use the melody of a song you know, such as "Happy Birthday" or "Row, Row, Row Your Boat," or make up your own tune.

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Use Words in Context

advantage	**foundation**	**mechanic**	**precaution**	**scheme**
agent	**genius**	**nuisance**	**pursuit**	**target**
challenge	**mainland**	**obstacle**	**rival**	**vehicle**

Directions Use your vocabulary words to name the two things in each item below. First, be sure you know what each word in boldface means. Then write your answers on the blanks.

1. Name two reasons why you would want to travel in a **vehicle** such as a car while exploring a new place. _____

_____

2. Name two things that would give you an **advantage** so that you would have a better chance while exploring. _____

_____

3. Name two **obstacles** that could prevent you from exploring a new place. _____

_____

4. Name two **precautions** that you would take to keep safe while you explore.

_____

5. Name two things that could be a **nuisance** or bother to you while you are exploring.

_____

6. Name two **challenges** you might face or have to overcome while exploring a new place.

_____

7. Name two **targets** you would want to reach while exploring. _____

_____

8. Name two reasons to explore the **mainland** rather than an island. _____

_____

Letter in a Bottle Imagine that you've gotten lost while exploring. Write a rescue note. Give enough information so that someone could find you. Include as many of your vocabulary words as you can. Try to use two new nouns, too. Underline the new nouns that you use.

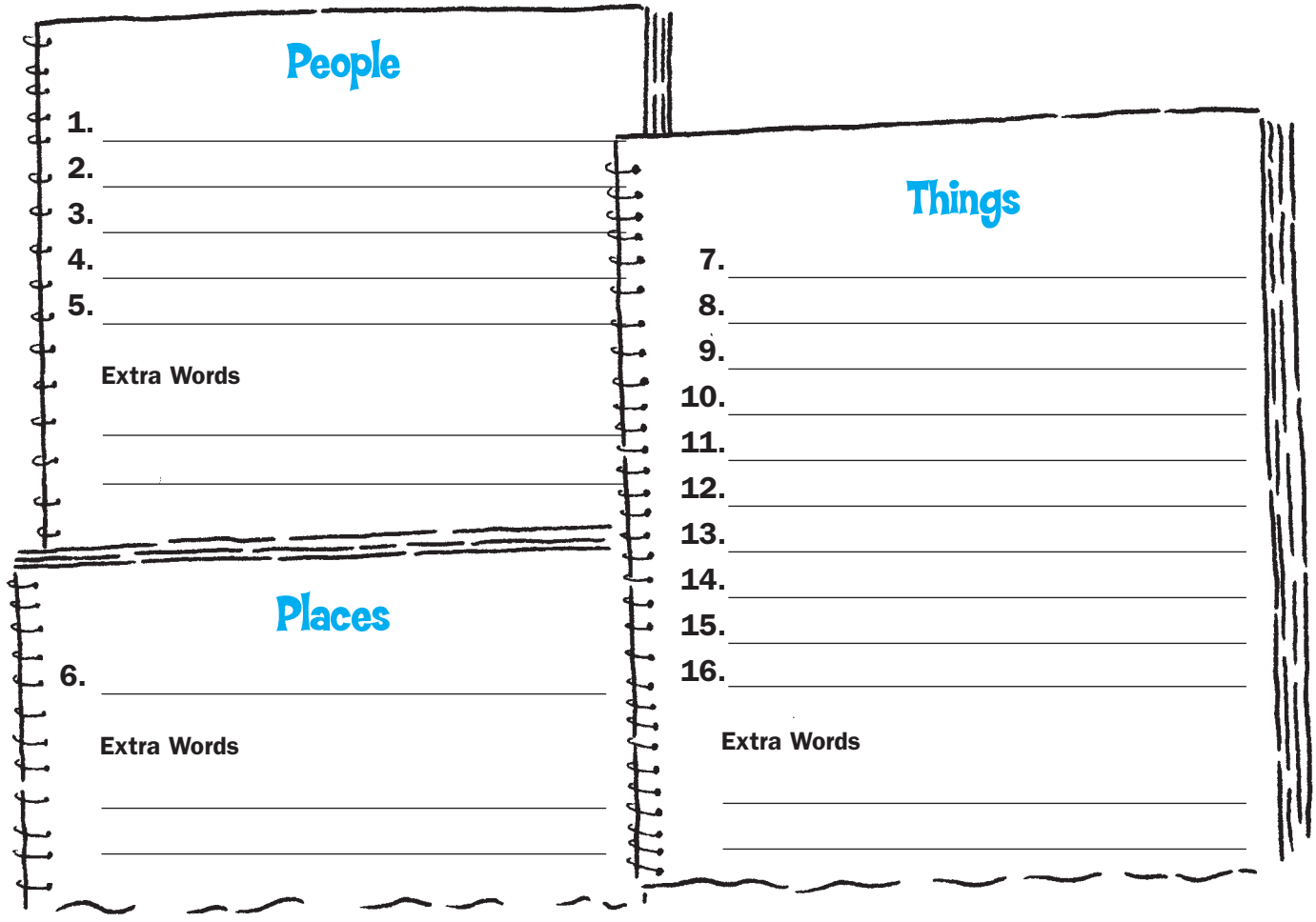
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Put Words Into Action

advantage	foundation	mechanic	precaution	scheme
agent	genius	nuisance	pursuit	target
challenge	mainland	obstacle	rival	vehicle

Directions Sort the nouns according to what they name. Write them on the appropriate journal page. (*Nuisance* can fit into more than one category.) Then add two more nouns to each category.



Create a Job Description Write a job description for a real or make-believe explorer. First indicate the qualities you think an explorer should have. Then tell the responsibilities of the job. Use as many of your vocabulary words as you can.

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Review and Extend

advantage	**foundation**	**mechanic**	**precaution**	**scheme**
agent	**genius**	**nuisance**	**pursuit**	**target**
challenge	**mainland**	**obstacle**	**rival**	**vehicle**

Learn More!

The **ending** of a noun may tell how many, or whether the noun is **singular** or **plural**. Some nouns add *-s* when they become plural. Nouns that end in *s, x, z, ch,* or *sh* add *-es*. Nouns that end in a consonant and *y* change the *y* to *i* and add *-es*.

Singular *(one person, place, or thing)*	**Plural** *(more than one person, place, or thing)*
comet	comets
box	boxes
pony	ponies

Directions Use your vocabulary words to answer the questions below. Add *-e, -es,* or *-ies* to make the nouns plural.

1. Good explorers should be remarkably smart and gifted people when it comes to solving problems. Which word could replace **remarkably smart and gifted people**? _____

2. Their opponents wanted to be the first to reach the North Pole. Which word could replace **opponents**? _____

3. Explorers face many barriers on their voyages. Which word could replace **barriers**? _____

4. There are many annoyances too, like bugs! Which word could replace **annoyances**? _____

5. But these brave men and women reach their goals. Which word could replace **goals**? _____

Write a News Story Write a news story about a place you would like to explore. Try to answer the questions Who? What? When? Where? Why? and How? Use as many of your vocabulary words as you can. Underline each vocabulary word. Then add some new nouns, too!

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Check Your Mastery



Directions Read each item below. Think about the meaning of the boldface word. Then fill in the circle by the item that best answers the question.

1. Which item below would be a **nuisance**?
- Ⓐ an adult who repairs your bike
- Ⓑ a friend playing a game with you
- Ⓒ a fly buzzing around your head

2. What might be an **obstacle** for you if you work as a babysitter?
- Ⓐ The baby cries a lot.
- Ⓑ You know and like the parents.
- Ⓒ The parents will only hire someone over 16.

3. What **precaution** should you take before sitting in the sun?
- Ⓐ Wear a sunscreen.
- Ⓑ Bring a radio.
- Ⓒ Ask a friend along.

4. A detective might ask a suspect questions in **pursuit** of what?
- Ⓐ a better job
- Ⓑ a friend
- Ⓒ the truth

5. What would be a **challenge** for a professional bike racer?
- Ⓐ breaking a speed record
- Ⓑ riding a short distance
- Ⓒ learning how to shift gears

Directions Write the vocabulary word that best answers each question.

6. If you made a flat base with brick or concrete, what are you most likely building? _____

7. If you decided to rake leaves to make extra money, what would your mother call your plan? _____

8. If you wanted someone to sell your house, who could you hire? _____

9. If your car broke, who would you call to repair it? _____

10. If you study hard, get a lot of sleep, and eat a good breakfast, what are you giving yourself? _____

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